

National Framework for Responsible Artificial Intelligence Governance

Department of Technology & Innovation
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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This framework establishes mandatory guidelines for the development, deployment, and oversight of artificial intelligence systems within federal agencies and their contracted partners. It applies to all AI systems that: (a) make or support decisions affecting individuals' rights, benefits, or opportunities; (b) process personally identifiable information (PII); (c) operate in safety-critical environments; or (d) are deployed at scale affecting more than 10,000 individuals.

2. DEFINITIONS

Term	Definition
Artificial Intelligence (AI)	A machine-based system that can, for a given set of human-defined objectives, make predictions or decisions.
High-Risk AI System	An AI system whose failure or misuse could result in significant harm to individuals, groups, or society.
Algorithmic Impact Assessment	A systematic evaluation of an AI system's potential effects on individuals and communities, including bias, discrimination, and privacy impacts.
AI Governance Board	The designated oversight body responsible for reviewing and approving the deployment of high-risk AI systems.
Explainability	The degree to which an AI system's outputs and decision-making process can be understood by humans.

3. CORE PRINCIPLES

3.1 Transparency. AI systems must provide clear documentation of their capabilities, limitations, and decision-making processes. Users must be informed when they are interacting with an AI system.

3.2 Fairness and Non-Discrimination. AI systems must be designed and tested to minimize bias across protected characteristics including race, gender, age, disability, and socioeconomic status. Regular bias audits must be conducted at minimum quarterly.

3.3 Accountability. Every AI system must have a designated human owner responsible for its performance, safety, and compliance. Automated decisions with significant impact must include a mechanism for human review and appeal.

3.4 Privacy and Security. AI systems must comply with all applicable data protection regulations. Data minimization principles shall apply: systems must collect and process only the minimum data necessary for their intended purpose. All training data must be inventoried and its provenance documented.

3.5 Safety and Reliability. High-risk AI systems must undergo rigorous testing, including adversarial testing, before deployment. Continuous monitoring must be implemented to detect performance degradation, drift, or emerging risks.

4. RISK CLASSIFICATION FRAMEWORK

Risk Level	Criteria	Requirements	Review Cycle
Minimal	No impact on individual rights; internal use only; documentation	Self-assess only	Annual
Limited	Indirect impact; recommendation systems; impact assessments; bias testing; monitoring	Impact assessments; bias testing; monitoring	Semi-annual
High	Direct impact on rights, benefits, employment; external use; government board approval	FOIA, external audit, government board approval	Quarterly; continuous monitoring
Unacceptable	Social scoring; real-time biometric surveillance; manipulation of deployed units	Prohibit, ban, or remove from deployment in any circumstances	

5. COMPLIANCE TIMELINE

All federal agencies must achieve compliance according to the following schedule:

Milestone	Deadline	Responsible Party
Inventory all existing AI systems	March 31, 2025	Agency CTO
Complete risk classification for all systems	June 30, 2025	AI Governance Board
Submit Algorithmic Impact Assessments for High-Risk systems	September 30, 2025	System Owners
Implement continuous monitoring for High-Risk systems	December 31, 2025	System Owners
First external audit cycle completed	March 31, 2026	Independent Auditor

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